

“On all economic and developmental issues, we received full support from all G20 countries. One of India’s focus areas is women-led development. If you put women in leadership roles, you bring in greater digital and financial inclusion”

AMITABH KANT
G20 Sherpa, former CEO, NITI Aayog

Philipp Ackermann and Australian high commissioner Barry R. O’Farrell hoped the issue would be positively tackled in September’s declaration, Israeli ambassador Naor Gilon said India could use its good ties with Russia for a positive outcome. However, VIF director Arvind Gupta echoed Kant and said G20 wasn’t the right forum for the conflict, and foreign policy expert C. Raja Mohan said G20 was itself under huge pressure and even a statement on Ukraine wouldn’t make a difference. All foreign dignitaries expressed admiration at India’s ongoing presidency and acknowledged its leadership in the digital empowerment of the masses.

Earlier, in her address, Liz Mohn, honorary member of the board of trustees of Bertelsmann Stiftung, said that in a world riven by crises, India’s role as a mediator and bridge-builder is more important than ever during its G20 presidency. She said fact-based international dialogue and face-to-face exchanges are fundamental to resolving international conflicts. ■

“Fact-based dialogue and face-to-face exchanges are fundamental to resolving global conflicts. Amidst all the uncertainty, India’s role as a mediator and bridge-builder is more important than ever”

LIZ MOHN
Honorary member, board of trustees, Bertelsmann Stiftung

